

Contents

Keep Me Ready — Founder Vision v1	1
Table of Contents	1
1. The Problem Worth Solving	1
2. The Founding Insight	2
3. Who We Are Building For	3
The Job Seeker in Transition	3
The Early-Career Professional Between Clients	3
The Career Changer Building Credibility	3
The Small Business Owner Who Handles Their Own Books	4
4. What We Believe	4
5. What Makes Us Different	5
6. The Product Vision	5
7. The Opportunity	6
8. How We Measure Success	6
9. What We Will Not Do	7
10. The Road Ahead	7

Keep Me Ready — Founder Vision v1

Prepared: June 2026

Version: 1.0

Author: Founder, Keep Me Ready

Table of Contents

1. The Problem Worth Solving
2. The Founding Insight
3. Who We Are Building For
4. What We Believe
5. What Makes Us Different
6. The Product Vision
7. The Opportunity
8. How We Measure Success
9. What We Will Not Do
10. The Road Ahead

1. The Problem Worth Solving

Bookkeeping is one of the most in-demand, accessible, and economically stable career paths available to people without a four-year degree. It requires no physical labor, no commute to a fixed location, and no graduate education. Skilled bookkeepers support

almost every small business that exists. The work is transferable across industries, can be done remotely, and pays a living wage from day one.

And yet the gap between “I studied for this” and “I feel confident doing this” is massive — and almost nobody is helping people close it.

Here is what the current landscape looks like for most bookkeepers:

Study phase: Certifications like QuickBooks ProAdvisor, NACPB Bookkeeper, and Bookkeeper Launch sell video courses, flashcards, and practice tests. These tools are designed to get a credential. They are not designed to build the deep, automatic fluency that comes from sustained daily practice.

Job phase: Once people are employed, they stop practicing foundational concepts entirely. They learn the specific workflows of their employer and let everything else drift. When that job ends — through a layoff, a client engagement finishing, a career change — they discover that their confidence in the fundamentals has quietly eroded.

Gap phase: Between jobs, between certifications, or between client engagements, there is almost no low-friction tool designed to keep bookkeeping skills sharp. The options are: go back to expensive certification prep courses, watch YouTube videos without structure, or do nothing and hope the knowledge stays.

Most people choose the third option. It does not go well.

The problem is not intelligence or motivation. The problem is that no one has built the daily habit layer for bookkeeping professionals — something accessible enough to do for ten minutes before work, engaging enough to do consistently, and useful enough to feel professionally meaningful.

2. The Founding Insight

The insight that drove Keep Me Ready is simple, and it comes from research on skill retention rather than education theory:

Competence is not a state you achieve. It is a state you maintain.

Cramming for a certification and passing it does not mean you have internalized the concepts. You have loaded them into working memory long enough to pass a test. Studies on skill decay consistently show that without regular retrieval practice, knowledge degrades — not to zero, but to a level of unreliability that hurts performance when it matters most.

This is not a character flaw in learners. It is a predictable consequence of how human memory works.

The second insight is about *how* professional confidence is built. Most ed-tech products are implicitly built around the model of testing — you answer questions, the product tells you if you are right or wrong, and you feel judged accordingly. This creates a relationship with practice that people avoid rather than return to. Nobody wants to feel graded when they are trying to grow.

The model we are building around is **coaching, not assessment**. A drill is not a test. It is a coaching moment. The goal is not to score you. The goal is to move your thinking one step forward from where it was before you started. That reframe changes everything about how questions are written, how feedback is delivered, and how progress is displayed.

The third insight is about compounding. Small daily habits, maintained consistently over time, produce learning outcomes that sporadic intensive study cannot match. A learner who does one focused ten-minute drill every weekday for a year has retrieval-practiced every foundational bookkeeping concept dozens of times. That learner will walk into any accounting interview or client meeting with a kind of relaxed fluency that cramming simply cannot produce.

These three insights — competence requires maintenance, coaching beats assessment, and consistency compounds — are the foundation on which every product decision in Keep Me Ready is built.

3. Who We Are Building For

The Job Seeker in Transition

Sarah finished the Bookkeeper Launch program six months ago. She got her certificate. She applied for jobs, got close on several, but hasn't landed one yet. In the meantime, her confidence in the fundamentals has been quietly slipping. She knows debits and credits conceptually, but when she thinks about walking into an interview and explaining a bank reconciliation out loud, she feels a knot in her stomach. She doesn't need another course. She needs ten minutes a day to stay sharp while she searches.

The Early-Career Professional Between Clients

Marcus is a freelance bookkeeper. He has two clients, but one just ended a six-month engagement. He has a gap of four to six weeks before his next client starts. He is not in study mode. He doesn't want to sign up for another certification. He wants something that keeps him in the game — something he can open every morning over coffee that takes less than fifteen minutes and reminds him that he still has his skills.

The Career Changer Building Credibility

Priya spent twelve years in retail management before deciding to pivot to accounting services. She is three months into her online bookkeeping program. She is learning quickly, but the volume of new concepts is overwhelming, and she doesn't trust her ability to retain them. She needs a daily low-stakes environment where she can practice what she is learning, see it explained differently, and build the quiet confidence that comes from having seen a concept twenty times rather than three.

The Small Business Owner Who Handles Their Own Books

David runs a ten-person landscaping company. He does his own books. He has always done them. But he is self-taught, and he is aware that there are gaps in his knowledge — things he handles by feel rather than by principle. He is not trying to become a professional bookkeeper. He wants to feel less anxious about his own financials and be able to have a real conversation with his CPA without nodding along to things he doesn't understand.

These four people are not abstractions. They represent the range of people who will find Keep Me Ready through a Google search, a Reddit thread, a friend's recommendation, or a certification program's community. What they share is not demographics. What they share is a specific emotional state: they are people who have invested in building a skill, and they do not want to lose it.

4. What We Believe

These are the principles that guide every product decision we make.

Practice, not testing.

A drill is a coaching moment, not a performance review. We never frame sessions as tests. There is no pass/fail threshold. There is no shame in a low score. There are only explanations, coaching notes, and the invitation to try again tomorrow.

Reflection builds mastery.

Knowing the right answer is not the same as understanding the concept. We build deliberate reflection into every drill through the "Compare Perspectives" feature and the Learning Journal. A learner who writes down how their thinking shifted after a session is doing a qualitatively different kind of learning than one who just taps through answers.

Progress compounds.

Small consistent effort outperforms large sporadic effort. Our streak system, session history, and Learning Journal are all designed to make the compounding of small daily habits visible to the learner. We are not trying to sell urgency. We are trying to build the long-term relationship between a professional and their own skill development.

Friction is the enemy.

If starting a drill requires more than two taps, we have failed. If a learner needs to remember a password, set up a profile, or navigate a complex UI before they can practice, we have already lost them. The path from arriving at the app to answering the first question must be as short as possible.

Coaching language everywhere.

Every piece of copy in the app — answer explanations, score screen messages, reflection prompts, journal confirmations — is written to sound like a good mentor, not a teacher with a red pen. The difference is real and it matters.

Anonymous play is a right, not a trial.

We will never nag anonymous users to create an account. We will never degrade their

experience to coerce a sign-up. An anonymous learner should get 100% of the drill and feedback experience. Account creation is an offer, not a gate.

5. What Makes Us Different

There are other bookkeeping practice tools. There are flashcard apps, certification prep platforms, and YouTube channels. Here is why Keep Me Ready is a different category:

We are not certification prep. Certification prep tools are optimized for a one-time event: passing an exam. Their incentive is to get you to the test as quickly as possible. Our incentive is to keep you practicing indefinitely — not because we want to retain you as a subscriber, but because ongoing practice is the actual product. Retention is proof of value, not a growth tactic.

We are not a flashcard app. Flashcard apps are passive retrieval tools with no coaching layer, no contextual explanation, and no narrative arc for the learner. They show you a card. You flip it. That's it. We provide multiple-choice and scenario questions with per-option coaching notes, topic lesson cards, a post-drill review, a model response comparison, and a journal to capture evolving thinking. The feedback density is completely different.

We are built around the professional identity. Most learning apps are designed for students. We are designed for professionals — people who already have some knowledge, who take pride in their competence, and who want to maintain their edge. Our tone, our copy, and our framing reflect that. We talk to our users as the skilled professionals they are, not as beginners who need to be convinced that learning is worthwhile.

The Learning Journal is a professional artifact. No other tool in this space asks learners to document how their thinking is evolving and turns that into a record they can keep. Over time, a learner's journal becomes evidence of their professional growth — something they could reference in an interview, share with a mentor, or simply read when they need to remember how far they have come.

6. The Product Vision

In three years, Keep Me Ready is the daily practice layer for the bookkeeping and accounting profession.

A working professional opens the app every morning the way they check the news or make coffee. It takes ten minutes. The drill is focused on today's topic. The explanation after each question tells them something they already half-knew but now understand more clearly. They write a sentence in their journal about one thing that clicked. They close the app and go to work feeling sharp.

At the end of a year, they have completed over two hundred drills. Their dashboard shows a steady accuracy improvement across every topic. Their journal has fifty

entries documenting their evolving mastery. When they walk into an interview or sit down with a new client, they feel the difference.

The instructor and employer layer comes next. Bookkeeping program directors, accounting firms, and certification providers can create cohorts in Keep Me Ready. They assign topic sequences. They monitor aggregate performance by topic. They see which concepts their learners are struggling with and adjust their curriculum accordingly. Keep Me Ready becomes the daily practice infrastructure that bridges the gap between their instruction and their learners' on-the-job competence.

Eventually, Keep Me Ready expands to adjacent domains: tax preparation, payroll processing, accounts receivable management. Any professional skills domain where competence requires maintenance, not just initial acquisition, is a domain where Keep Me Ready belongs.

7. The Opportunity

The United States alone has approximately 1.7 million bookkeeping, accounting, and auditing clerks, and that number does not include the millions of small business owners who manage their own finances, the hundreds of thousands of students currently in bookkeeping programs, or the large population of career changers entering the profession each year.

The professional skills practice market is undersupplied. Most ed-tech investment has gone into initial skill acquisition — bootcamps, certification programs, and online courses. Almost no investment has gone into ongoing maintenance of professional skills for people who have already completed their initial education. This is the gap Keep Me Ready occupies.

The business model is straightforward: free unlimited practice for anonymous and signed-in learners drives adoption and demonstrates value. A subscription tier unlocks advanced question banks, mastery tracking, cross-device journal sync, and streak protection features. An institutional tier serves training programs, accounting firms, and certification providers who want cohort analytics and curriculum integration.

The go-to-market is community-first: the bookkeeping communities on Reddit, Facebook, and LinkedIn are large, active, and hungry for tools that actually help them stay sharp. Organic discovery through these communities, combined with search traffic from people preparing for bookkeeping interviews and certifications, is enough to reach meaningful early traction without paid acquisition.

8. How We Measure Success

We will know Keep Me Ready is working when:

The daily return rate is the primary metric. If learners come back tomorrow without being nagged, the product is doing its job. A daily active rate above 30% for

signed-in users within their first thirty days is the early signal we are looking for.

Learning Journal entries compound. The average number of journal entries per active user is a proxy for the depth of engagement we are creating. A learner with fifty journal entries is not a passive consumer — they are an active participant in their own professional development. We want to watch this number grow.

Accuracy improves over time. The admin dashboard already tracks per-user improvement between early and recent sessions. At scale, we want to see a clear upward trend in accuracy for learners who stay with the product for sixty days or more. That trend is the proof that the tool is actually producing learning outcomes.

Learners tell us it helped them get a job or keep a client. This is qualitative, but it is the most meaningful signal. When someone emails us to say they walked into an interview feeling ready for the first time, or that they caught a client's error because they drilled journal entries last week, that is the outcome we are optimizing for.

9. What We Will Not Do

These are the constraints we hold intentionally.

We will not gamify anxiety. We will not show countdown timers during questions, penalize wrong answers with point deductions, or create competitive leaderboards. Those mechanics produce stress responses that are incompatible with the calm, open mindset that produces good learning.

We will not paywalled explanations. The coaching layer — explanations, per-option coaching notes, lesson cards, model responses — will always be free. Paywalling the thing that makes us educationally valuable would betray the product's core premise.

We will not expand too fast. Adding intermediate and advanced question banks before the beginner experience is genuinely excellent would dilute the product. Expanding to new professional domains before the bookkeeping experience is proven would dilute the focus. Depth before breadth.

We will not treat learners as metrics. Streak counts, accuracy percentages, and session tallies are tools for helping learners see their own progress. They are not weapons for manipulating behavior. We will not send “your streak is about to break!” push notifications designed to generate anxiety-driven engagement.

10. The Road Ahead

The immediate priorities, in order, are:

Make the daily habit stickier. The drill experience is built. The feedback layer is built. The next investment is in the small signals that make a learner feel that

coming back tomorrow is worth it — better streak visualizations, milestone acknowledgments for the Learning Journal, and a morning reminder email that earns its open rate because it says something useful.

Sync the Learning Journal to the cloud. Right now, journal entries live in local Storage and are device-specific. Moving them to Supabase is the single most important feature on the near-term roadmap. A learner who has written forty journal entries and loses them because they switched devices or cleared their browser data will not come back.

Build the intermediate and advanced question banks. The 72 beginner questions cover the six foundational categories well. Intermediate questions should introduce variance, edge cases, and multi-step reasoning. Advanced questions should introduce professional judgment, scenario complexity, and the kind of nuanced understanding that separates competent from excellent.

Ship the cohort/instructor tier. The admin dashboard already exists for a single administrator. Extending it to support multiple instructors, named cohorts, and curriculum-level reporting is the unlock for institutional partnerships. One partnership with a bookkeeping certification program or a regional accounting firm validates the institutional model.

Stay close to the learner. The most important thing we can do right now is talk to the people using the product. Why do they come back? What do they wish it did differently? What question explanations feel wrong? What topics feel underrepresented? The answers to those questions will shape the next twelve months of product development more than any strategic framework.

Keep Me Ready exists because professional competence is worth protecting — and because the people who have worked hard to build it deserve a tool built with the same care and intention they bring to their work.

Practice makes permanent.